Capgemini Global Business Travel & Expense Policy

Document ID: POL-FIN-002-V2
Version: 2024.3
Effective Date: February 1, 2024
Last Updated: January 15, 2024
Owner: Global Finance & Procurement
Access Level: Internal - All Employees

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1. Vision and Philosophy

Capgemini is a global organization that thrives on collaboration and client proximity. Business travel is often necessary to deliver value. However, we are also committed to our "Net Zero" sustainability goals. This policy balances the need for travel with cost-efficiency, employee safety, and environmental responsibility.

2. The "Think Before You Fly" Initiative

Before booking any travel, employees must consider:

1. **Virtual First:** Can this meeting be held effectively via Microsoft Teams or Zoom?
2. **Regional Hubs:** Is there a local team member who can attend on your behalf?
3. **Trip Batching:** Can multiple client meetings be scheduled in one trip to reduce total travel?
4. **Carbon Impact:** For trips with similar cost and timing, select the option with the lowest carbon score in the TMS.
5. **Client Requirements:** Confirm client site access rules, security clearance needs, and onsite badge lead time.

3. Pre-Travel Authorization

3.1 The Travel Request (TR)

All travel (domestic and international) requires an approved TR in the Travel Management System (TMS) before any bookings are made.

- **Domestic Travel:** Approval required from the immediate manager (Grade D and above).
- **International Travel:** Approval required from the Department Head and Finance Controller.
- **Exceptions:** Emergency travel (e.g., critical system failure at client site) can be approved post-facto within 24 hours.

3.2 Required TR Details

TRs must include:

- **Business Purpose:** Client name, project code, and expected outcomes.
- **Itinerary:** Cities, dates, and preferred travel windows.
- **Budget Estimate:** Air, lodging, ground, and per diem.
- **Billability:** Whether costs are client-billable or internal.

- **Risk Indicators:** Any high-risk destination flags or special medical needs.

3.3 Booking Channels

- **Mandatory Channels:** Travel must be booked through the TMS or approved travel agency for duty-of-care tracking.
- **Off-Platform Bookings:** Reimbursement is not guaranteed unless pre-approved by Finance.

4. Air Travel Standards

4.1 Preferred Airlines

Capgemini has negotiated corporate rates with "Alliance Partners" (e.g., Star Alliance, SkyTeam). Employees must select preferred carriers unless a non-partner airline is at least 20% cheaper for the same route.

4.2 Booking Timelines

- **Domestic:** Minimum 14 days in advance.
- **International:** Minimum 21 days in advance.
- Late bookings (within 7 days) require a "Justification for Late Booking" note in the TMS.

4.3 Cabin Class Policy

- **Economy Class:** Default for all flights under 6 hours.
- **Premium Economy:** For flights between 6 and 10 hours for employees at Grade D and above.
- **Business Class:**
    - For flights exceeding 10 hours for Grade E (VP) and above.
    - For overnight flights where the employee is expected to work immediately upon arrival.
- **First Class:** Strictly prohibited for all levels of employees.

4.4 Baggage and Seat Selection

- **Baggage:** One checked bag is reimbursable for trips longer than 2 nights.
- **Seat Upgrades:** Paid seat selection is allowed for safety or medical needs; upgrades are not reimbursable unless approved in advance.

4.5 Flight Changes and Cancellations

- **Changes:** Use the TMS to rebook when schedules shift; change fees are reimbursable only with documented business need.
- **No-Shows:** No-show fees are not reimbursable.

5. Accommodation and Lodging

5.1 Hotel Selection

Employees must use the "Capgemini Preferred Hotels" list found in the TMS. These hotels have been vetted for safety, proximity to Capgemini offices, and sustainability practices.

5.2 Maximum Nightly Rates (Updated 2024)

- **Group A Cities (London, NY, Zurich, Singapore):** $300
- **Group B Cities (Paris, San Francisco, Tokyo):** $220
- **Group C Cities (Mumbai, Bangalore, Madrid):** $130
- *Rates include breakfast but exclude taxes.*

5.3 Booking with Family

If a family member accompanies an employee, the employee is responsible for any incremental costs (e.g., double occupancy vs. single).

5.4 Extended Stays

If a stay is extended for personal reasons:

- The business portion must be clearly documented.
- The employee covers incremental room, tax, and personal expenses.
- Any cost savings from weekend stays may be applied to the business portion.

6. Ground Transportation

6.1 Rail Travel

For journeys under 4 hours (e.g., London to Paris, NY to DC), rail travel is the mandatory default over air travel to support carbon reduction.

6.2 Car Rentals

- **Category:** Only "Compact" or "Intermediate" classes are permitted.
- **Insurance:** Employees should decline the rental agency's insurance as Capgemini's corporate policy provides global coverage.
- **Fuel:** Cars must be returned with a full tank to avoid the agency's premium refueling surcharges.

6.3 Ride-Sharing and Taxis

- Use of Uber/Lyft is encouraged where safe.
- "Premium" or "Black" car services are non-reimbursable unless for group travel with 3+ employees.

6.4 Personal Vehicle Use

- **Mileage:** Reimbursed at the locally published corporate mileage rate.
- **Tolls/Parking:** Reimbursable with receipts.
- **Commuting:** Daily commuting to a regular office is not reimbursable.

7. Meals and Incidental Expenses (M&IE)

7.1 Per Diem Model

Capgemini utilizes a fixed daily allowance to simplify accounting:

- **Domestic (US/EU):** $65/day.
- **International:** Based on the Mercer Cost of Living Index (refer to TMS Appendix).
- **Adjustments:** If a meal is provided by a client or during a conference, the per diem must be reduced by 25% for lunch and 40% for dinner.

7.2 Actuals Model (Client-Billable)

For client-facing roles where expenses are recharged to the client, "Actuals" may be claimed with receipts. Limits are dictated by the specific Client-Service Agreement (CSA).

7.3 Tips and Gratuities

Reasonable tips are reimbursable when customary:

- **Meals:** Up to 18% of the bill.
- **Taxis/Rideshare:** Up to 15% of the fare.
- **Hotel Staff:** Up to $5 per service instance.

8. Entertainment and Business Meals

- **Ratio:** At least one external client/prospect must be present.
- **Limit:** $100 per person (including alcohol, which must be consumed in moderation).
- **Documentation:** Must include a list of all attendees and the specific business topic discussed.
- **Pre-Approval:** Required for events exceeding $500 total.
- **Alcohol:** Cannot be billed to a client unless explicitly permitted in the CSA.

9. Non-Reimbursable Expenses (The "No-Go" List)

The following will NOT be reimbursed under any circumstances:

- Traffic or parking fines.
- In-flight Wi-Fi (unless for a critical project).
- Laundry services for trips under 5 days.
- Mini-bar snacks and alcohol.
- Lost luggage replacement (covered by travel insurance).
- Pet sitting or house sitting fees.
- Spa, gym, or sauna fees.
- Airline lounge memberships.
- Personal subscriptions or streaming services.
- Travel booked with loyalty points without prior approval.

10. Expense Reporting and Audits

10.1 Submission Window

Expenses must be submitted within 30 days of the trip completion. Reports submitted after 90 days are automatically rejected.

10.2 Audit Process

- **Random Audits:** 10% of all reports are selected for manual audit.
- **Flagged Items:** Any expense exceeding the limit by 5% will be flagged for "Manager Justification."
- **Receipts:** Digital copies are sufficient; physical receipts must be kept for 6 months for tax purposes.

10.3 Currency Conversion

Expenses incurred in foreign currency must be converted using:

- The exchange rate provided by the corporate card provider on the transaction date, or
- The TMS exchange rate when paid via personal funds.

10.4 Reimbursement Timeline

- **Standard:** Reimbursements are processed within 10 business days after approval.
- **Missing Information:** Reports with incomplete data are returned within 3 business days for correction.

11. Travel Safety and Insurance

11.1 SOS International

All traveling employees are covered by SOS International for medical emergencies and evacuations. The contact number is on the back of every corporate credit card.

11.2 High-Risk Areas

Travel to "Level 3" or "Level 4" countries (as per State Dept/Foreign Office) requires a security briefing and approval from the Global Security Head.

11.3 Emergency Protocols

- **Check-In:** Travelers must respond to security check-ins within 6 hours.
- **Medical Emergencies:** Use SOS International first, then notify your manager and HR.

12. Sustainability and Carbon Tracking

Every travel booking in the TMS will display a "Carbon Score." Employees with the lowest annual carbon footprint in each department will be recognized during the annual "Green Awards."

- **Offsets:** For international trips exceeding 5,000 km, the department will fund a verified carbon offset.
- **Sustainable Choices:** Hotel and transport options with eco-certifications should be selected when cost variance is within 15%.

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